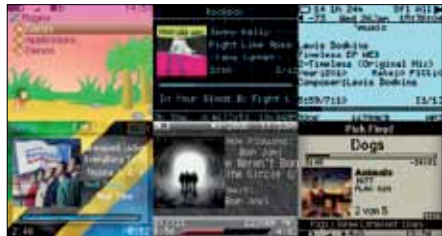


More codecs supported

There are a lot of codecs available in the market but each have their own licensing fee, so making more codecs available subsequently leads to a rise in the price. This is one of the primary reasons for many variants of PMPs existing with the same hardware but with varying support for codecs. Open source codecs on the other hand are capable of playing all of the various file formats but some tend to take a hit when it comes to sound quality. However, certain open source codes do better than the proprietary ones. As an example, Dirac an open source video codec developed by BBC turned out to be better than H.264 which is a proprietary codec.

Themes

Making your own theme has become an integral part of custom firmware. Getting more features wasn't enough so making stuff seem groovier by adding a personal touch had quite the appeal.



Rockbox themes

Plugins

There are plugins for everything. One can get a new interface altogether, get more applications (DOOM, the game runs well on most implementations of Rockbox). Then there are apps being developed for the popular custom firmware.

Greater control over your device

Now we all know how irritating it is when you need to use a particular software to get the job done. Moreover, these software come with their own quirks which include wiping out your entire collection if the device is connected to a new computer.

It's economical

Sometimes if you do your research well, you'll come across a method of making your humble PMP sound like its awesome counterpart by flashing it with the latter's firmware. This drastically alters the price-to-performance ratio of the device.